

FURMAN BISHOP

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ple last year when I benched him", he said. There was a touch of jubilation in his voice, for now he knows the Bronx is alive and paying attention again.

From the time he was nine, Blomberg was stronger and longer than anybody in his little league world. He is not now a home run hitter, but one who strings his power out like a clothes line. "If I hit home runs," he said, "They come with the swing."

They speak of him in whispers as the next Mickey Mantle, who sat down on the bench a way, but this, too is a punch line that Blomberg rolls with deftly. "I'm just going out to be the best player I can. If it works out I'm the next Mantle, then I guess I'm it."

Oh, fame. Oh, immortality, seize me if you must.